but the expected ground operations will necessarily change the parameters, and anything beyond that is shrouded in uncertainty.

The same uncertainty shrouds Israeli attitudes toward Palestinians in general and those of Gaza in particular. The attitude of Israeli Arabs is not considered relevant. (According to a poll from the Truman Institute at Hebrew University, nearly 80 percent of Israeli Arabs denounce Hamas's actions.) The fanatical prosettlement ideologists, and many Israelis, enraged by the atrocities of October 7, will demand some sort of retribution and may possibly vent their rage upon the Palestinian population. On the other hand, by now there are many Israelis who understand that the prewar policy of the settlers and their supporters (shown by Huwara) fueled Palestinian extremism, but that most Palestinians want to live in peace with Israel and merely go on with their daily life and regain their dignity, as the Truman Institute poll seems to demonstrate. These contradictory trends will find their contrary expression during the ground war. What is allowed and what is forbidden will depend on the decisions of a leadership that, in the eyes of many, has to be done away with.

In the meantime, there seems to be a serious rift between Netanyahu and Defense Minister Gallant. According to Israeli commentators, Netanyahu opposes an Israeli operation against Hezbollah, whereas Gallant is in favor of opening a second front in the North. If Hezbollah remains passive during the ground offensive against Gaza, Netanyahu will reap the praise; if not, this will be one more of his many mistaken assumptions and just another of the many questions he will have to answer.

Two female hostages, Judith (Yehudit) and Natalie Raanan, mother and daughter, were liberated thanks to the mediation of Qatar. They are American citizens who plan to settle in Israel. It may bolster the expectation that if nothing happens on the ground, more hostages will be freed. According to an IDF estimate there are still 210 hostages and prisoners in